CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 7: **Madam Rides the Bus (First Flight)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which statement best captures the author's view of childhood? 1

(a) Children long for dignity and discover harsh truths
(b) Children are only playful
(c) Children should obey
(d) Children never think

2. A suitable summary of the theme is: 1

(a) school is hard **(b)** innocence meets reality
(c) wealth brings joy **(d)** cities are noisy

3. In 'The bus coughed and started', the device is: 1

(a) simile **(b)** irony **(c)** personification **(d)** hyperbole

4. 'Death' in the story is treated: 1

(a) through a poem
(b) indirectly through the sight of a carcass
(c) through a speech
(d) through a long scene

5. How is suspense maintained? 1

(a) The secret trip and the danger of discovery
(b) a murder
(c) a war
(d) a chase

6. A suitable inference from Valli's silence on return is: 1

(a) she is angry **(b)** she has absorbed a new truth
(c) she is tired of buses **(d)** she is proud of the cow

7. Which element makes the story realistic? 1

(a) space **(b)** magic
(c) ghosts **(d)** common village details and a simple plot

8. The effect of describing Valli as 'a girl in search of experience' is: 1

(a) to show her laziness **(b)** to blame her
(c) to stress her adventurous spirit **(d)** to mock her

9. Which pair of contrasts is central to the story? 1

(a) rich and poor **(b)** innocence and experience
(c) north and south **(d)** day and night

10. The narrator's detachment allows the reader to: 1

(a) ignore the plot **(b)** laugh only
(c) sleep **(d)** see Valli's feelings and also judge her

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why might the author not describe Valli's return in detail? 2

12. Why does the author include a harsh image in a light story? 2

13. How does the author make a small journey meaningful? 2

14. Comment on the use of third-person narration. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the author's choice of diction in the cow scene convey emotion? 3

16. Compare Valli's perspective with that of an adult passenger. 3

17. Write a sentence each with 'dignity', 'distress' and 'carcass'. 3

OR

Assess the role of dialogue in revealing character. 3

18. Critically comment on the limited characterisation of minor figures in the story. 3

OR

Evaluate the translation of cultural details in the story. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on the theme of 'loss of innocence' in the story. 5

OR

Discuss the portrayal of village life and rural children in the story. 5

20. Write a short story of your own titled 'Sir/Madam Takes the Train'. 5

OR

Write a review of the story for the school magazine. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND